

Data and Metadata Profile

Data

For the Term Project, I've chosen the dataset "MyAnimeList Top 10,000 Anime Dataset" as found on Kaggle. The data are details surrounding the top 10,000 anime as determined by myanimelist.net, which is a database and forum for anime and manga. All data are scraped from the site, and include both real life information regarding production and other information, as well as in-universe data like details about characters.

The key stakeholders include user Furkan Arık on Kaggle, who created and maintains the dataset; the creators, actors, and production companies of the anime mentioned; fans of these series; any users on Kaggle who are in need of a comprehensive list of anime and details of said anime for any personal projects. In addition, Furkan Arık notes that because the dataset is structured with each file being relational to one another, it would be useful for "Data Engineering enthusiasts and Data Scientists who want to work with a real-world normalized relational database..."

There are eight files, seven of which include data and one of which includes metadata. The seven data files are all CSV files, and the metadata file is JSON. Because the dataset is constructed for SQL, all of the files are interconnected via unique identifiers for anime titles, characters, studio and production companies, and staff involved in production including writers and voice actors. Further data are provided like general statistics, roles of characters, and genres, comprising 21 unique variables across these files (not including foreign keys to other tables). No specific software is required to open these files, but a SQL server of some kind would likely be helpful with analysis and data retrieval, as the dataset has been constructed with relationality in mind.

The data do come with limited usage restrictions. They are licensed under Creative Commons as "Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike 4.0," which allows all people to share and adapt the material for non-commercial purposes as long as attribution is provided and changes to the material are indicated. The dataset further acknowledges that it "is for educational purposes only. All intellectual property related to the anime titles, descriptions, and images belongs to their respective creators and MyAnimeList."

Metadata

The dataset does have metadata in a JSON file, but the information contained within it is not distinct from the metadata included on the dataset's page on Kaggle. The JSON file includes Title, an ID, the Creative Commons license, a string Description of the dataset, two empty properties without any values attached called Collaborators and Resources, and finally update frequency. Kaggle's built-in metadata additionally include categories Authors, Coverage, and DOI Citation, all of which are empty, and Provenance which does include helpful information about the way data were scraped from myanimelist.net. Separately, the dataset has several tags on Kaggle (Movies and TV Shows, Data Analytics, Data Visualization, Exploratory Data Analysis, and Anime and Manga), although interestingly, I found the set through the tag Comics and Animation, which is not listed on the dataset's page.

I'd say that the metadata are not particularly comprehensive. I do not recognize the standard used, although the properties share some similarities to the ones used by Kaggle and may have been based off of them. I do think there must be a standard in play given the empty properties, but there is really not very much information provided by the file. I am also confused by the ID property, with the given value "senku/mal-top-10k," as I don't know where this identifier would be used.

Helpfully, each CSV file does include definitions for each variable in plain English. Each table also includes a summary of that table, and what its purpose is inside of the larger database. Further, there is also a very large "about" section that includes information about updates, normalization level, date formatting, and even the proper SQL joins for each file.

Enrichment

In terms of discoverability, the dataset actually does quite well on Kaggle's tags. Possibly because it's updated so frequently and because Kaggle ranks its usability so high, but it pops up first or close-to on many of the pop culture-related tags. The issue is there are no lists of tags on Kaggle, so it takes quite a bit of clicking around the website to find the data. Despite ranking first for these tags, when searching by keyword "anime," it's not found until page 4. I wonder if the weaker metadata impact that.

I do think that the data are very usable, given Furkan Arık's comprehensive about page. I think that that information would also be made more effective if included in a README in the dataset itself, rather than just being on Kaggle. There are also a few abbreviations that could be

clarified for people unfamiliar with anime (e.g., OVA). I think one of the biggest improvements to usability would be further clarifying some of the variables. These are scraped from, and thus defined by, MyAnimeList, but MAL does go into depth on their own site on how elements like “Rank” and “Score” are determined, and providing documentation for that or at least informing users how to find it would I think greatly enrich the data.

Publications

There are no publications linked to this dataset and I could not find any through searching either. I did peruse the UW library search (my go-to) as well as all UW databases via EBSCO, but I really only found one article that specifically used data from MyAnimeList, which the authors had scraped themselves. I think the largest problem is that this is not the only dataset that has gathered this sort of data from MAL, and so even if I were to find other articles, from a cursory look it can be hard to tell if this specific set was used.

Repository Profile

For the MyAnimeList Top 10,000 Anime Dataset I’ve chosen [GitHub](#) as the most appropriate repository. Because it is a general purpose repository open to everybody, it is a better choice than the other, more research data-focused repositories found on re3data. It is usually intended for storing and sharing code. While the set I have chosen technically does not include any code, the dataset is intended to be used to create .sql files, which could themselves additionally be uploaded to this repository. The main barrier for uploading files to the repository is having an account, which is free to create. According the [Get Started](#) (Uploading a Project to GitHub, n.d.) page, this is the only prerequisite. Any person with an account is eligible to contribute.

Scope

There are no stated limits to what can be deposited with regards to data type, domain, or file format. Because GitHub uses Git, it can technically [“store and handle any file of any type,”](#) (Git - Gitfaq Documentation, n.d.) but some files are better suited to the repository than others (e.g., text-based formats vs. binary formats). There are also certain limits on what the interface can process. For example, while the interface can render CSV or TSV files as interactive tables, this only works for files [under 512 kb in size](#) (Working with Non-Code Files, n.d.).

The only guidance provided regarding what should be in the Submission Information Package is a recommended README. The only necessary items are a name for the project, and how visible the submitter wants the project to be (public or private). Aside from the README markdown file, submitters can also add a .gitignore. [According to GitHub](#), “you can create a .gitignore file in your repository's root directory to tell Git which files and directories to ignore when you make a commit. To share the ignore rules with other users who clone the repository, commit the .gitignore file into your repository” (Ignoring Files, n.d.). The final item you can add is a license, as, per [GitHub](#), “for your repository to truly be open source, you'll need to license it so that others are free to use, change, and distribute the software” (Licensing a Repository, n.d.). However, none of these items are technically necessary to submit, and no other metadata is required.

Access

Human assistance or consulting at GitHub is exclusively contacting their support team for troubleshooting: in order to specifically talk to a human, [a ticket must be submitted](#) (Contacting GitHub Support, n.d.), but GitHub also puts effort in redirecting questions to CoPilot before trying to get real human support. That being said, paid users of GitHub have a slightly different experience, including email support and even 24/7 callback support for users who pay for “[GitHub Premium Support](#)” (GitHub Support Documentation, n.d.). The other avenue for non-paid users to talk to humans is via [GitHub community discussions](#) (Community, n.d.), which is a forum in which users can ask questions of other users.

While a login is required to submit support tickets, engage with the forum, or upload data, it is not required to download any files off of the repository. However, making too many requests of the server while not signed in leads to a “Too Many Requests” error that advises the user has “exceeded a secondary rate limit” and that “signing in may provide a higher rate limit.” This appears to be a protection against data scraping directly from GitHub. While direct file download is available for all files hosted, many file types are also viewable directly on the website, as long as they are not too large. For some files types (e.g., .py or .sql), this may just be the code, but for .csv files or others, small enough files can actually be previewed as tables and searched in site (alongside also being able to view the code). The previously referenced “[Working with non-code files](#)” page (n.d.) provides more information regarding how different types of files can be rendered on the GitHub website.

There does not appear to be a specific metadata standard that GitHub uses. The basic metadata provided to each submission is an about tab that includes a link to activity on the submission, as well as the number of users who have either “starred” or “watched” the set. It

also includes the number of “forks” from the set, that is the number of people who have created a server-copy of the submission that they can alter without altering the original work. There is also separate information regarding “published releases” and “published packages” featuring the submission. Other metadata can be added. Users can add tags to their submissions for better searchability. Other optional metadata include version release information, information about contributors, and coding languages used. Custom properties are also possible. The Dissemination Information Package, then, much like the SIP, does not appear to be distinct from what is actually stored by GitHub, but do not include the metadata inputted on the site, only the files uploaded to or created on it.

Of note, submitters can choose the permission settings in what others can view of what they upload. There are two options for repository visibility: public and private. Public allows all users on GitHub to view and fork your repository, makes changes to the repository viewable as “activity,” makes actions visible to all, and disables “push rulesets,” that is rules that “can block pushes to a private or internal repository and that repository's entire fork network based on file extensions, file path lengths, file and folder paths, and file sizes” (n.d.). On the other hand, private repositories start as only viewable to their creators, and then collaborators can be added via username or email.

Additional Information

Citation

The following is the citation that would be most apt for the dataset’s location on GitHub, written in APA Style 7th Edition:

Arik, F. (2026, January 12). LIS545-Final-Project [Dataset]. Kaggle. GitHub.
<https://github.com/spo2240/LIS545-Final-Project>

Considerations for Preservation

There are fortunately very many things going for this dataset that could help ensure its long-term preservation. Of the files in this dataset, seven are CSV files, and one is a JSON file. Both of these are widely used, non-proprietary, open formats, and neither are particularly in danger of becoming obsolete. While both of these file formats are viewable in GitHub without additional software, they are not recognized natively by computers and do need software to open them offline. For CSV files, most spreadsheet programs, like Excel or Numbers, are

serviceable software for these files, and so are thus easily viewable. Without a JSON viewer, JSON files can be opened in a text editor or directly into any browser, and so are also easily viewable.

Ethical and Legal Considerations

On Kaggle, creator Furkan Arik has the dataset licensed as CC BY-NC-SA 4.0, which, as previously mentioned, is the Creative Commons “Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike 4.0.” This allows all users to share and adapt the material for non-commercial purposes with attribution provided and changes to the material indicated. The dataset also notes that it is for educational purposes only, and credits ownership of all intellectual property to their respective creators.

This dataset has no human subjects, and so needs very few human subject considerations. The data that does exist related to humans is exclusively information surrounding voice actors, producers, and other staff working on the anime listed. Their names are public information, and provided so as to give them credit. To anonymize their information would likely be more unethical, and at the very least useless, given its public nature.

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